

GRAPE VINES *Vitis vinifera*

Scrambling grape vines are highly ornamental as well as productive, and look wonderful trained over an arch or used to create a screen. Grapes can be grown for wine-making or for eating fresh—some grape varieties are suitable for both—although sweet dessert grapes will need to be grown under cover in cool climates. If you don't have much space, grow a vine in a container and train it into a standard.

	SPRING	SUMMER	FALL	WINTER
PLANT				
HARVEST				

PLANTING INDOORS

Vines can be planted under cover in a greenhouse, or planted just outside and trained through a hole in the wall or vent. Planting outside and training in will mean that you do not need to water the vine, since its roots will run deep outside. However, the soil will warm up more slowly.

If you plant vines inside, you will need to ensure that you give the plant the water, nutrients, and soil conditions that it needs. Grow indoor grape vines as cordons, and allow them about 3–4 ft (1–1.2 m) space. Some varieties suit containers.

PLANTING OUTDOORS

Grape vines are quite tolerant of most soil types: ideally, they like



Buy only certified disease-free plants.

a neutral pH. Plant vines out in early spring, at a depth of about 12 in (30 cm). Grapes are vigorous plants both above and below ground—and however you choose to train your vine you will need to give it plenty of space: cordons 3–4 ft (1–1.2 m); guyots 3 ft (1 m); and double guyots 5–6 ft (1.5–2 m) (see tip box on p.110 for details).